

- (ii) **Linear polynomial** A polynomial of degree 1, is called linear polynomial. e.g. $9x + 7$, $x - 9$, $x + 2$ etc.
- (iii) **Quadratic polynomial** A polynomial of degree 2, is called quadratic polynomial.
The general form of quadratic polynomial in x is $ax^2 + bx + c$, where a , b and c are real and $a \neq 0$.
e.g. $x^2 - 7x + 12$, $5y^2 - 7$, $z^2 - 4$ etc., are all quadratic polynomials.
- (iv) **Cubic polynomial** A polynomial of degree 3, is called cubic polynomial.
The general form of a cubic polynomial in x is $ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$, where a , b , c and d are real and $a \neq 0$.
e.g. $3x^3 + 2x^2 + 7x - 1$, $8y^3 + 5y + 2$, $x^3 - 8$ etc., are all cubic polynomials.
- (v) **Biquadratic polynomial** A polynomial of degree 4, is called a biquadratic polynomial.
The general form of a biquadratic polynomial in x is $ax^4 + bx^3 + cx^2 + dx + e$, where a , b , c , d and e are real numbers and $a \neq 0$.
e.g. $6x^4 + 3x^3 + 2x^2 + x + 2$, $x^4 - 8$ etc., are all biquadratic polynomials.

Based on Number of Terms

- (i) **Monomial** A polynomial containing only one term is called a monomial. e.g. $6x^2$
- (ii) **Binomial** A polynomial containing two terms is called a binomial. e.g. $5x^3 + 7xy$
- (iii) **Trinomial** A polynomial containing three terms is called a trinomial. e.g. $7x^2y + 5x + 6$

FACTORISATION

To express a polynomial as the product of other polynomials of degree less than that of the given polynomial is called as factorisation.

e.g. $x^2 - 49 = x^2 - 7^2 = (x - 7)(x + 7)$

Important Identities

- $(a^2 - b^2) = (a + b)(a - b)$
- $(a + b)^2 = a^2 + b^2 + 2ab$ and $(a - b)^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab$
- $(a + b)^2 - (a - b)^2 = 4ab$
- $(a + b)^2 + (a - b)^2 = 2(a^2 + b^2)$
- $(a + b)^3 = a^3 + b^3 + 3ab(a + b)$
- $(a - b)^3 = a^3 - b^3 - 3ab(a - b)$
- $(a^3 + b^3) = (a + b)(a^2 + b^2 - ab)$

- $(a^3 - b^3) = (a - b)(a^2 + b^2 + ab)$
- $(a + b + c)^2 = a^2 + b^2 + c^2 + 2(ab + bc + ac)$
- $a^3 + b^3 + c^3 - 3abc = (a + b + c)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - ab - bc - ac)$
- If $a + b + c = 0$, then $a^3 + b^3 + c^3 = 3abc$
- $a^4 + a^2b^2 + b^4 = (a^2 + ab + b^2)(a^2 - ab + b^2)$

Methods of Factorisation

These methods are given below

Factorisation by Taking Out the Common Factor

If each term of an expression has a common factor, take out the common factors.

EXAMPLE 1. Factorise value of $4(3a - 2b)^2 - 5(3a - 2b)$ is

- a. $(3a - 2b)(12a - 8b - 5)$ b. $(2a - 3b)(12a - 8b)$
c. $(2a - 3b)(8a - 12b - 5)$ d. None of these

Sol. a. $4(3a - 2b)^2 - 5(3a - 2b) = (3a - 2b)[4(3a - 2b) - 5]$
 $= (3a - 2b)[12a - 8b - 5]$

Factorisation by Grouping

Sometimes in a given polynomial, it is not possible to take out a common factor directly. However, on rearranging the terms of the polynomial and grouping them such that all the terms have a common factor, the polynomial can be easily factorised.

EXAMPLE 2. Factorise $x^2 + y - xy - x$

- a. $(x - y)(x + 1)$ b. $(x - y)(x^2 - 1)$
c. $(x + y)(x^2 + 1)$ d. $(x - y)(x - 1)$

Sol. d. **Method I** $x^2 + y - xy - x = x^2 - x + y - xy$
 $= x(x - 1) + y(1 - x) = x(x - 1) - y(x - 1) = (x - 1)(x - y)$

Method II $x^2 + y - xy - x = x^2 - xy + y - x$
 $= x(x - y) - 1(x - y) = (x - y)(x - 1)$

EXAMPLE 3. Factorise $x^2 + \frac{4}{x^2} + 4 - 2x - \frac{4}{x}$

- a. $\left(x - \frac{2}{x}\right)\left(x + \frac{2}{x} + 2\right)$ b. $\left(x - \frac{2}{x}\right)\left(x + \frac{2}{x} - 2\right)$
c. $\left(x + \frac{2}{x}\right)\left(x + \frac{2}{x} - 2\right)$ d. None of these

Sol. c. $\left(x^2 + \frac{4}{x^2} + 4 - 2x - \frac{4}{x}\right) = \left(x^2 + \frac{4}{x^2} + 4\right) - 2\left(x + \frac{2}{x}\right)$
 $= \left(x + \frac{2}{x}\right)^2 - 2\left(x + \frac{2}{x}\right) = \left(x + \frac{2}{x}\right)\left(x + \frac{2}{x} - 2\right)$

Factorisation of Perfect Square Polynomials

If the polynomial is given as the perfect square quadratic polynomial, then use the following Identities to factorise it.

$$\bullet a^2 + 2ab + b^2 = (a + b)^2 \quad \bullet a^2 - 2ab + b^2 = (a - b)^2$$

EXAMPLE 4. Factorise $16x^2 - 8x + 1$

a. $(2x-1)^2$ b. $(x-4)^2$ c. $(x-2)^2$ d. $(4x-1)^2$

Sol. d. $16x^2 - 8x + 1 = (4x)^2 - 2(4x) + 1^2 = (4x - 1)^2$
 $= (4x - 1)(4x - 1)$

EXAMPLE 5. Factorise $x^2 - 2\sqrt{5}x + 5$

a. $(x\sqrt{5}-1)^2$ b. $(x-5)^2$ c. $(x+\sqrt{5})(x-\sqrt{5})$ d. $(x-\sqrt{5})^2$

Sol. d. $x^2 - 2\sqrt{5}x + 5 = x^2 - 2\sqrt{5}x + (\sqrt{5})^2 = (x - \sqrt{5})^2$
 $= (x - \sqrt{5})(x - \sqrt{5})$

Factorising the Difference of Two Squares

In case, the polynomial is given in the form of $a^2 - b^2$, to evaluate it, following identity is applied.

$$\bullet a^2 - b^2 = (a - b)(a + b)$$

EXAMPLE 6. Factorise $2a^5 - 32a$

a. $(a^2 + 4)(a - 2)(a + 2)$ b. $2a(a^2 + 4)(a - 2)(a + 2)$
 c. $2a(a^2 + 4)$ d. None of these

Sol. b. $2a^5 - 32a = 2a(a^4 - 16)$
 $= 2a[(a^2)^2 - (4)^2] = 2a(a^2 + 4)(a^2 - 4)$
 $= 2a(a^2 + 4)(a^2 - 2^2) = 2a(a^2 + 4)(a - 2)(a + 2)$

Factorisation of Quadratic Polynomials

Quadratic polynomials of the type $ax^2 + bx + c$, where $a \neq 0$, a and b are coefficients of x^2 and x respectively and c is constant, can be factorised by splitting the middle term. We find two numbers p and q such that

$$p + q = b \text{ and } pq = ac, \text{ then}$$

$$ax^2 + bx + c = ax^2 + (p + q)x + c = ax^2 + px + qx + c$$

EXAMPLE 7. Factorise $x^2 + 9x + 14$

a. $(x + 2)(x + 7)$ b. $(x - 2)(x - 7)$
 c. $(x + 2)(x - 7)$ d. $(x - 2)(x + 7)$

Sol. a. $x^2 + 9x + 14 = x^2 + (7 + 2)x + 14 = x^2 + 7x + 2x + 14$
 $= x(x + 7) + 2(x + 7) = (x + 7)(x + 2)$

EXAMPLE 8. Factorise $4\sqrt{3}x^2 + 5x - 2\sqrt{3}$

a. $(2x + \sqrt{3})(4x - \sqrt{3})$ b. $(2x - \sqrt{3})(4x + \sqrt{3})$
 c. $(\sqrt{3}x + 2)(4x - \sqrt{3})$ d. None of these

Sol. c. $4\sqrt{3}x^2 + 5x - 2\sqrt{3} = 4\sqrt{3}x^2 + 8x - 3x - 2\sqrt{3}$

$$\begin{aligned} & [\because 4\sqrt{3} \times (-2\sqrt{3}) = -24 = 8 \times (-3)] \\ & = 4x(\sqrt{3}x + 2) - \sqrt{3}(\sqrt{3}x + 2) \\ & = (\sqrt{3}x + 2)(4x - \sqrt{3}) \end{aligned}$$

Factorisation of Sum and Difference of Cubes

In case, the polynomial is given in the form of $a^3 + b^3$ or $a^3 - b^3$. To factorise it, following identities can be applied.

$$\bullet a^3 + b^3 = (a + b)(a^2 - ab + b^2)$$

$$\bullet a^3 - b^3 = (a - b)(a^2 + ab + b^2)$$

EXAMPLE 9. Factorise $(2x + 3y)^3 - (2x - 3y)^3$

a. $18(4x^2 + 3y^2)$ b. $18y(3x^2 + 4y^2)$
 c. $xy(4x^2 + 3y^2)$ d. $18y(4x^2 + 3y^2)$

Sol. d. $(2x + 3y)^3 - (2x - 3y)^3$

Put $2x + 3y = a$ and $2x - 3y = b$

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow a^3 - b^3 &= (a - b)(a^2 + ab + b^2) = (2x + 3y - 2x + 3y) \\ & \quad [(2x + 3y)^2 + (2x + 3y)(2x - 3y) + (2x - 3y)^2] \\ &= 6y[4x^2 + 9y^2 + 12xy + 4x^2 - 9y^2 + 4x^2 \\ & \quad + 9y^2 - 12xy] \\ &= 6y[12x^2 + 9y^2] = 18y[4x^2 + 3y^2] \end{aligned}$$

Hence, $(2x + 3y)^3 - (2x - 3y)^3 = 18y[4x^2 + 3y^2]$

Factorisation of Polynomial of form $a^3 + b^3 + c^3 - 3abc$

Here, it is easy to use.

$$\begin{aligned} \bullet a^3 + b^3 + c^3 - 3abc &= (a + b + c)(a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - ab - bc - ac) \\ \bullet \text{ If } a + b + c = 0, \text{ then } a^3 + b^3 + c^3 &= 3abc \end{aligned}$$

EXAMPLE 10. Factorise $x^3 + 27y^3 + 8x^3 - 18xyz$

a. $(x + 3y + 2z)(x^2 + 9y^2 + 4z^2 + 3xy + 6yz + 2xz)$
 b. $(x + 3y + 2z)(x^2 + 9y^2 + 4z^2 - 3xy - 6yz - 2xz)$
 c. $(x - 3y - 2z)(x^2 + 9y^2 - 4z^2 - 3xy + 6yz + 2xz)$
 d. None of the above

Sol. b. $x^3 + 27y^3 + 8z^3 - 18xyz$

$$\begin{aligned} &= x^3 + (3y)^3 + (2z)^3 - 3(x)(3y)(2z) \\ &= (x + 3y + 2z)[x^2 + 9y^2 + 4z^2 - x(3y) \\ & \quad - 3y(2z) - x(2z)] \\ &= (x + 3y + 2z)[x^2 + 9y^2 + 4z^2 - 3xy - 6yz - 2xz] \end{aligned}$$

EXAMPLE 11. Factorise

$$(2x - 3y)^3 + (3y - 5z)^3 + (5z - 2x)^3$$

a. $3(2x - 3y)(3y - 5z)(5z - 2x)$
 b. $(2x - 3y)(3y - 5z)(5z - 2x)$
 c. $3(2x - 3y)(3y + 5z)(5z - 2x)$
 d. None of the above

Sol. a. Here, $2x - 3y = a$, $3y - 5z = b$ and $5z - 2x = c$

$$\begin{aligned}\therefore a + b + c &= 0 \Rightarrow a^3 + b^3 + c^3 = 3abc \\ \therefore (2x - 3y)^3 + (3y - 5z)^3 + (5z - 2x)^3 &= 3(2x - 3y)(3y - 5z)(5z - 2x)\end{aligned}$$

Remainder Theorem

Let $p(x)$ be a polynomial of degree n greater than or equal to 1 (i.e. $n \geq 1$) and a be any real number. If $p(x)$ is divided by the linear polynomial $(x - a)$, then the remainder is $p(a)$. Remainder can be evaluated by substituting $x - a = 0$, i.e. $x = a$ in $p(x)$.

EXAMPLE 12. The remainder when $12x^3 - 13x^2 - 5x + 9$ is divided by $(3x + 2)$ is

- a. 1 b. 2 c. 3 d. 0

Sol. c. Let $p(x) = 12x^3 - 13x^2 - 5x + 9$ and $q(x) = 3x + 2$
When $p(x)$ is divided by $(3x + 2)$, then remainder is $p\left(\frac{-2}{3}\right)$.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Now, } p\left(\frac{-2}{3}\right) &= 12\left(\frac{-2}{3}\right)^3 - 13\left(\frac{-2}{3}\right)^2 - 5\left(\frac{-2}{3}\right) + 9 \\ &= 12 \times \left(\frac{-8}{27}\right) - 13 \times \frac{4}{9} + \frac{10}{3} + 9 = 3\end{aligned}$$

Hence, the required remainder is 3.

Factor Theorem

Let $p(x)$ be a polynomial, if degree $n \geq 1$ and a be any real number. Then,

- If $p(a) = 0$, then $(x - a)$ is a factor of $p(x)$.
- If $(x - a)$ is a factor of $p(x)$, then $p(a) = 0$.

EXAMPLE 13. For what values of k will $4x^5 + 9x^4 - 7x^3 - 5x^2 - 4kx + 3k^2$ contain $x - 1$ as a factor?

- a. 3, $-\frac{1}{2}$ b. 3, -1 c. 0, $\frac{1}{3}$ d. 1, $\frac{1}{3}$

Sol. d. Given, $P(x) = 4x^5 + 9x^4 - 7x^3 - 5x^2 - 4kx + 3k^2$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Since, } (x - 1) \text{ is a factor of } P(x). \therefore P(1) &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow 4 \times (1)^5 + 9 \times (1)^4 - 7 \times (1)^3 - 5 \times (1)^2 - 4 \times k \times (1) + 3 \times k^2 &= 0 \\ \Rightarrow 3k^2 - 4k + 1 &= 0 \Rightarrow 3k^2 - 3k - k + 1 = 0 \\ \Rightarrow (3k - 1)(k - 1) &= 0 \Rightarrow k = \frac{1}{3}, 1\end{aligned}$$

Division Synthetic Algorithm

If $p(x)$ and $g(x)$ any two polynomials with $g(x) \neq 0$, then we can find polynomials $q(x)$ and $r(x)$ such that

$$p(x) = g(x) \times q(x) + r(x)$$

i.e. Dividend = (Divisor $\times$ Quotient) + Remainder

where, $r(x) = 0$ or degree of $r(x) <$ degree of $g(x)$, then we say that $p(x)$ divided by $g(x)$, gives $q(x)$ as quotient and $r(x)$ as remainder.

If the remainder $r(x)$ is zero, we say that divisor $g(x)$ is a factor of $p(x)$.

EXAMPLE 14. If two factors of $a^4 - 2a^3 - 9a^2 + 2a + 8$ are $(a + 1)$ and $(a - 1)$, then what are the other two factors?

- a. $(a - 2)$ and $(a + 4)$ b. $(a + 2)$ and $(a + 4)$
c. $(a + 2)$ and $(a - 4)$ d. $(a - 2)$ and $(a - 4)$

Sol. c. Let $f(a) = a^4 - 2a^3 - 9a^2 + 2a + 8$
and $(a + 1)$ and $(a - 1)$ are two factors of $f(a)$.
Now, by division method,

$$\begin{array}{r} a^2 - 1 \quad a^4 - 2a^3 - 9a^2 + 2a + 8 \quad (a^2 - 2a - 8) \\ \underline{a^4 - 2a^3 - 8a^2 + 2a + 8} \\ - 2a^3 \qquad \qquad 2a \\ \underline{- 8a^2 \qquad \qquad + 8} \\ - 8a^2 \qquad \qquad + 8 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

So, the required factor of $f(a)$ is $(a^2 - 2a - 8)$.
Further factorise it by splitting the middle term, i.e.

$$\begin{aligned}a^2 - 2a - 8 &= a^2 - 4a + 2a - 8 \\ &= a(a - 4) + 2(a - 4) = (a + 2)(a - 4)\end{aligned}$$

Hence, $(a + 2)$ and $(a - 4)$ are other two factors of $f(a)$.

Factorisation of Polynomials Using Factor Theorem

To factorise the polynomial, follow the following steps

- Let $p(x)$ be a given polynomial.
- find all the possible factors of constant term in $p(x)$.
- Take any one of the factors, say (α) and find $p(\alpha)$. If $p(\alpha) = 0$ the $(x - \alpha)$ is a factor of $p(x)$.
- Divide the polynomial $p(x)$ by $(x - \alpha)$ to find its all other factors.

EXAMPLE 15. Factorise $2x^3 - 5x^2 - 19x + 42$.

- a. $(x - 2)(2x - 7)(x + 3)$ b. $(x + 2)(2x + 7)(x - 3)$
c. $(x - 1)(3x - 7)(x - 4)$ d. $(2x + 3)(4x - 7)(x - 1)$

Sol. a. Let $p(x) = 2x^3 - 5x^2 - 19x + 42$

Hence, constant term is 42 and its all factors are $\pm 1, \pm 2, \pm 3, \pm 6, \pm 7, \pm 14, \pm 21$ and ± 42 .

$$\begin{aligned}\text{At } x = 1, \quad p(1) &= 2(1)^3 - 5(1)^2 - 19 + 42 \\ &= 2 - 5 - 19 + 42 = 20 \neq 0\end{aligned}$$

So, $(x - 1)$ is not a factor of $p(x)$.

$$\text{At } x = 2, \quad p(2) = 2(2)^3 - 5(2)^2 - 19(2) + 42 = 58 - 58 = 0$$

So, $(x - 2)$ is a factor of $p(x)$.

Now, on dividing $p(x)$ by $(x - 2)$, we get $(2x^2 - x - 21)$ as quotient i.e. other factor of $p(x)$.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{So, } p(x) &= (x - 2)[2x^2 - x - 21] \\ &= (x - 2)(2x^2 - 7x + 6x - 21) \\ &= (x - 2)[x(2x - 7) + 3(2x - 7)]\end{aligned}$$

$$\therefore p(x) = (x - 2)(2x - 7)(x + 3)$$

> PRACTICE EXERCISE

- If $x = 5, y = 3$ and $z = 2$, then the value of $x^2 + y^2 + z^2 - 2xy + 2yz - 2zx$ is
(a) 125 (b) 0 (c) -25 (d) 10
- The factors of $x^2 - 2\sqrt{3}x + 3$ are
(a) $(x + \sqrt{3})^2$ (b) $(x - \sqrt{3})^2$
(c) $(x + \sqrt{3})(x - \sqrt{3})$ (d) $(x + 2)(x + \sqrt{3})$
- The factors of $(a^4b^4 - 16c^4)$ are
(a) $4(a^2b^2 + c^2)(ab - 2c)(ab + 2c)$
(b) $(a^2b^2 - 4c^2)(ab + 2c)^2$
(c) $(a^2b^2 + 4c^2)(ab + 2c)(ab - 2c)$
(d) $(a^2b^2 - 4c^2)^2(ab + 2c)(ab + 4c)$
- The factors of $(x^8 - y^8)$ are
(a) $(x^4 + y^4)(x^2 + y^2)(x + y)(x - y)$
(b) $(x^2 + y^2)^2(x + y)(x - y)$
(c) $(x^4 + y^4)(x^2 + y^2)^2$
(d) $(x^2 + y^2)(x - y)^2$
- The factors of $\left(a^2 + a + \frac{1}{4}\right)$ are
(a) $\left(a + \frac{1}{2}\right)^2$ (b) $\left(a + \frac{1}{2}\right)(a + 2)$
(c) $\left(a + \frac{1}{2}\right)\left(a - \frac{1}{2}\right)$ (d) $\left(a - \frac{1}{2}\right)^2$
- The factors of $8 - 4x - 2x^3 + x^4$ are
(a) $(2 - x)(4 - x^3)$ (b) $(2 + x)(4 - x^3)$
(c) $(2 + x)(3 - x^3)$ (d) $(2 - x)(x^3 - 4)$
- The factors of $(a^2 - b^2 - 4ac + 4c^2)$ are
(a) $(a + 2c + b)(a - 2c - b)$ (b) $(a - 2c + b)(a - 2c - b)$
(c) $(a - 2b + c)(a + b + 2c)$ (d) $(a - 2b)(a + 2b + 2c)$
- What are the factors of $x^2 + 4y^2 + 4y - 4xy - 2x - 8$?
(a) $(x - 2y - 4)$ and $(x - 2y + 2)$
(b) $(x - y + 2)$ and $(x - 4y + 4)$
(c) $(x - y + 2)$ and $(x - 4y - 4)$
(d) $(x + 2y - 4)$ and $(x + 2y + 2)$
- Factorise $a^3 - \frac{1}{a^3} - 2a + \frac{2}{a}$
(a) $\left(a + \frac{1}{a}\right)\left(a^2 + \frac{1}{a^2}\right) - 2\left(a - \frac{1}{a}\right)$
(b) $\left(a - \frac{1}{a}\right)\left(a^2 + \frac{1}{a^2} + 1\right) + 2\left(a - \frac{1}{a}\right)$
(c) $\left(a + \frac{1}{a}\right)\left(a - \frac{1}{a}\right)$
(d) None of the above
- What are the factors of $\left(\frac{1}{3}x^2 - 2x - 9\right)$?
(a) $\frac{1}{3}(x - 9)(x + 3)$ (b) $\frac{1}{3}(x - 9)(x - 3)$
(c) $\frac{1}{3}(x + 9)(x + 3)$ (d) $\frac{1}{3}(x + 9)(x - 3)$
- What are the factors of $(6\sqrt{3}x^2 - 47x + 5\sqrt{3})$?
(a) $(3\sqrt{3}x + 5\sqrt{3})(2x - 5\sqrt{3})$
(b) $(3\sqrt{3}x - 5\sqrt{3})(x\sqrt{3}x + 1)$
(c) $(2x + 5\sqrt{3})(3\sqrt{3}x + 1)$
(d) $(2x - 5\sqrt{3})(3\sqrt{3}x - 1)$
- The factors of $(8a^3 + 125b^3 - 64c^3 + 120abc)$ are
(a) $(2a + 5b - 4c)(2a + 5b + 4c)$
(b) $(2a - 5b - 4c)(2a + 5b + 4c)$
(c) $(2a + 5b - 4c)(4a^2 + 25b^2 + 16c^2 - 10ab + 20bc + 8ac)$
(d) $(2a + 5b + 4c)(4a^2 + 25b^2 + 16c^2 - 10ab + 20bc + 8ac)$
- If $x^{1/3} + y^{1/3} + z^{1/3} = 0$, then
(a) $x + y + z = 0$ (b) $(x + y + z)^3 = 27xyz$
(c) $x + y + z = 3xyz$ (d) $x^3 + y^3 + z^3 = 0$
- If $x + \frac{1}{x} = \sqrt{5}$, then the value of $x^3 + \frac{1}{x^3}$ is
(a) $8\sqrt{5}$ (b) $2\sqrt{5}$ (c) $5\sqrt{5}$ (d) $7\sqrt{5}$
- If $\left(x + \frac{1}{x}\right) = 6$, then $\left(x^2 + \frac{1}{x^2}\right)$ is equal to
(a) 32 (b) 38 (c) 34 (d) 44
- If $x - \frac{1}{x} = \frac{1}{3}$, then what is $9x^2 + \frac{9}{x^2}$ equal to?
(a) 18 (b) 19 (c) 20 (d) 21
- If $a + b + c = 6$ and $a^2 + b^2 + c^2 = 26$, then what is $ab + bc + ca$ equal to?
(a) 0 (b) 2 (c) 4 (d) 5
- If $(x^4 + x^{-4}) = 322$, then what is one of the value of $(x - x^{-1})$?
(a) 18 (b) 16 (c) 8 (d) 4
- If $a + b + c = 0$, then what is the value of $\frac{a^2}{bc} + \frac{b^2}{ca} + \frac{c^2}{ab}$?
(a) -3 (b) 0 (c) 1 (d) 3
- If $a + b + c = 10$ and $ab + bc + ca = 31$, then the value of $a^2 + b^2 + c^2$ is
(a) 48 (b) 38 (c) 28 (d) 18

- 21.** The factors of $x^2 + \frac{1}{4x^2} + 1 - 2x - \frac{1}{x}$ are
 (a) $\left(x - \frac{1}{2x}\right)\left(x - \frac{1}{2x} + 2\right)$ (b) $\left(x + \frac{1}{2x}\right)\left(x + \frac{1}{2x} - 2\right)$
 (c) $\left(x - \frac{1}{2x}\right)\left(x - \frac{1}{2x} - 2\right)$ (d) $\left(x + \frac{1}{2x}\right)\left(x - \frac{1}{2x} - 2\right)$
- 22.** The factors of $(a^2 - b^2)(c^2 - d^2) - 4abcd$ are
 (a) $(ac + bd + bc + ad)(ac - bd - bc - ad)$
 (b) $(ac - bd - bc + ad)(ac + bd + dc + ab)$
 (c) $(ac - bd + bc + ad)(ac - bd - bc - ad)$
 (d) $(ac - bd - bc - ad)(ac + bd + dc + ab)$
- 23.** If 'a' is an integer such that $a + \frac{1}{a} = \frac{17}{4}$, then the value of $\left(a - \frac{1}{a}\right)$ is
 (a) 4 (b) $\frac{13}{4}$ (c) $\frac{17}{4}$ (d) $\frac{15}{4}$
- 24.** $x^4 + 4y^4$ is divisible by which one of the following?
 (a) $(x^2 + 2xy + 2y^2)$ (b) $(x^2 + 2y^2)$
 (c) $(x^2 - 2y^2)$ (d) None of these
- 25.** If $x(x + y + z) = 9$, $y(x + y + z) = 16$ and $z(x + y + z) = 144$, then x equal to
 (a) $\frac{9}{5}$ (b) $\frac{9}{7}$ (c) $\frac{9}{13}$ (d) $\frac{16}{13}$
- 26.** If $x = (b - c)(a - d)$, $y = (c - a)(b - d)$ and $z = (a - b)(c - d)$, then what is $x^3 + y^3 + z^3$ equal to?
 (a) xyz (b) $2xyz$ (c) $3xyz$ (d) $-3xyz$
- 27.** If the expression $(px^3 + x^2 - 2x - q)$ is divisible by $(x - 1)$ and $(x + 1)$, what are the values of p and q respectively?
 (a) 2, -1 (b) -2, 1 (c) -2, -1 (d) 2, 1
- 28.** If the expression $px^3 + 3x^2 - 3$ and $2x^3 - 5x + p$ when divided by $x - 4$ leave the same remainder, then what is the value of p ?
 (a) -1 (b) 1 (c) -2 (d) 2
- 29.** Let $f(x) = a_0x^n + a_1x^{n-1} + a_2x^{n-2} + \dots + a_{n-1}x + a_n$, where $a_0, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ are constants. If $f(x)$ is divided by $ax - b$, the remainder is
 (a) $f\left(\frac{b}{a}\right)$ (b) $f\left(-\frac{b}{a}\right)$ (c) $f\left(\frac{a}{b}\right)$ (d) $f\left(-\frac{a}{b}\right)$
- 30.** Which one of the following statements is correct?
 (a) Remainder theorem is a special case of factor theorem
 (b) Factor theorem is a special case of remainder theorem
 (c) Factor theorem and remainder theorem are two independent results
 (d) None of the above
- 31.** What is $x(y - z)(y + z) + y(z - x)(z + x) + z(x - y)(x + y)$ equal to?
 (a) $(x + y)(y + z)(z + x)$ (b) $(x - y)(x - z)(z - y)$
 (c) $(x + y)(z - y)(x - z)$ (d) $(y - x)(z - y)(x - z)$
- 32.** If the remainder of the polynomial $a_0 + a_1x + a_2x^2 + \dots + a_nx^n$ when divided by $(x - 1)$ is 1, then which one of the following is correct?
 (a) $a_0 + a_2 + \dots = a_1 + a_3 + \dots$
 (b) $a_0 + a_2 + \dots = 1 + a_1 + a_3 + \dots$
 (c) $1 + a_0 + a_2 + \dots = -(a_1 + a_3 + \dots)$
 (d) $1 - a_0 - a_2 - \dots = a_1 + a_3 + \dots$
- 33.** If u, v and w are real numbers such that $u^3 - 8v^3 - 27w^3 = 18uvw$, then which one of the following is correct?
 (a) $u - v + w = 0$ (b) $u = -v = -w$
 (c) $u - 2v = 3w$ (d) $u + 2v = -3w$
- 34.** The value of $(a^{1/8} + a^{-1/8})(a^{1/8} - a^{-1/8})(a^{1/4} + a^{-1/4})(a^{1/2} + a^{-1/2})$ is
 (a) $(a + a^{-1})$ (b) $(a - a^{-1})$ (c) $(a^2 + a^{-2})$ (d) $(a^2 - a^{-2})$
- 35.** The polynomial $f(x) = x^4 - 2x^3 + 3x^2 - ax + b$, when divided by $(x - 1)$ and $(x + 1)$ leaves the remainders 5 and 19, respectively. The values of a and b are
 (a) $a = 4, b = 3$ (b) $a = 3, b = 4$
 (c) $a = 5, b = 8$ (d) $a = 9, b = 7$
- 36.** If the expression $ax^2 + bx + c$ is equal to 4 when $x = 0$, leaves a remainder 4 when divided by $x + 1$ and a remainder 6 when divided by $x + 2$, then the values of a, b and c are respectively:
 (a) 1, 1, 4 (b) 2, 2, 4 (c) 3, 3, 4 (d) 4, 4, 4
- 37.** If $(x^{3/2} - xy^{1/2} + x^{1/2}y - y^{3/2})$ is divided by $x^{1/2} - y^{1/2}$ the quotient is
 (a) $x - y$ (b) $x + y$ (c) $x^{1/2} + y^{1/2}$ (d) $x^2 - y^2$
- 38.** If $9x^2 + 3px + 6q$ when divided by $3x + 1$ leaves a remainder $-\frac{3}{4}$ and $qx^2 + 4px + 7$ is exactly divisible by $x + 1$, then the values of p and q respectively are
 (a) $0, 7/4$ (b) $-7/4, 0$
 (c) $\frac{7}{4}, 0$ (d) None of these
- 39.** If $a + b + c = 1$, then which of the following statements are true?
 I. $(a + b)(b + c)(c + a) = bc + ac + ab - abc$
 II. $a^2 + b^2 - c^2 + 2ab = a + b - c$
 (a) Only I (b) Only II
 (c) Both I and II (d) Neither I nor II
- 40.** If $x + \frac{1}{x} = 4$, then the value of expression
 I. $x^3 + \frac{1}{x^3} = 52$ II. $x = 2 + \sqrt{3}$
 Which of the following is correct?
 (a) Only I (b) Only II
 (c) Neither I nor II (d) Both I and II